



Catchment-Aware Flood Forecasting System

R25-060

Meet our team...



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Introduction



- In Sri Lanka, flooding is a common and destructive phenomenon brought on by excessive rainfall.
- Given the ongoing nature of these weather events, it's crucial for residents to stay informed through official channels and adhere to safety advisories issued by authorities.
- Despite Sri Lanka's advanced technology, AI and IoT are underused for faster, accurate, and actionable flood forecasts.
- The study proposes a Catchment-Aware Flood Forecasting System using XAI, Edge Computing, and IoT to address these issues.

Objectives

Main objective

To develop an **IoT-integrated, edge-computing-based, and Explainable AI-driven flood forecasting system** that eliminates latency issues in real-time water level monitoring and enhances accuracy and speed.

Sub-objectives

- 1 Flood Impact Prediction and Resource Optimization System with Real-Time Delivery Monitoring
- 2 Visualization of flood-affected areas and suggesting alternative routes to the users who are affected by flood.
An IoT maintenance admin dashboard panel for device management.
- 3
- 4 Provide security guidance for flood-affected individuals to find safe sites and essential supplies.

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- Specialization: Information Technology



Introduction - Background

- **Floods** are a recurring natural disaster, especially in flood-prone regions like Sri Lanka.
- **Challenges in current flood management systems**
 - Limited predictive capabilities
 - Lack of integration between damage prediction and resource allocation
 - Insufficient real-time data for decision-making.
- **Need for a comprehensive flood management solution**
 - Integrated flood damage prediction
 - Real-time displacement forecasting
 - Optimized resource allocation strategies

Introduction - Background

- **Main objectives**
 - Improve flood damage prediction accuracy
 - Forecast displaced populations based on socio-economic data
 - Optimize resource allocation for efficient disaster response
- **System designed for scalability and integration**
 - Can be deployed for specific areas (e.g., Kelaniya River Basin)
 - Scalable to cover other flood-prone areas in Sri Lanka
- **Real-time actionable insights for stakeholders**
 - Donors, disaster management agencies, area managers, and safe site managers
 - Enhanced decision-making and flood response planning

Research Gap

Aspect	Existing system	Gap Identified
Socio-Economic Factors	Not fully integrated into damage and displacement predictions.	Our system incorporates socio-economic data for more accurate predictions.
Real-Time Data Integration	Uses static data (historical records) for predictions.	Lack of real-time flood data integration for dynamic predictions.
Displacement Forecasting	Predicted based on flood extent, often static.	Our system dynamically adjusts displacement forecasts based on real-time data and socio-economic factors.
Resource Allocation Optimization	Static resource allocation methods.	Uses Linear Programming (LP) for real-time optimization based on actual resource needs.
Stakeholder Communication	No real-time updates or interactive communication tools for stakeholders	Real-time updates for donors, managers, and responders on resource allocation, damage reports, and vehicle tracking.

Research Question

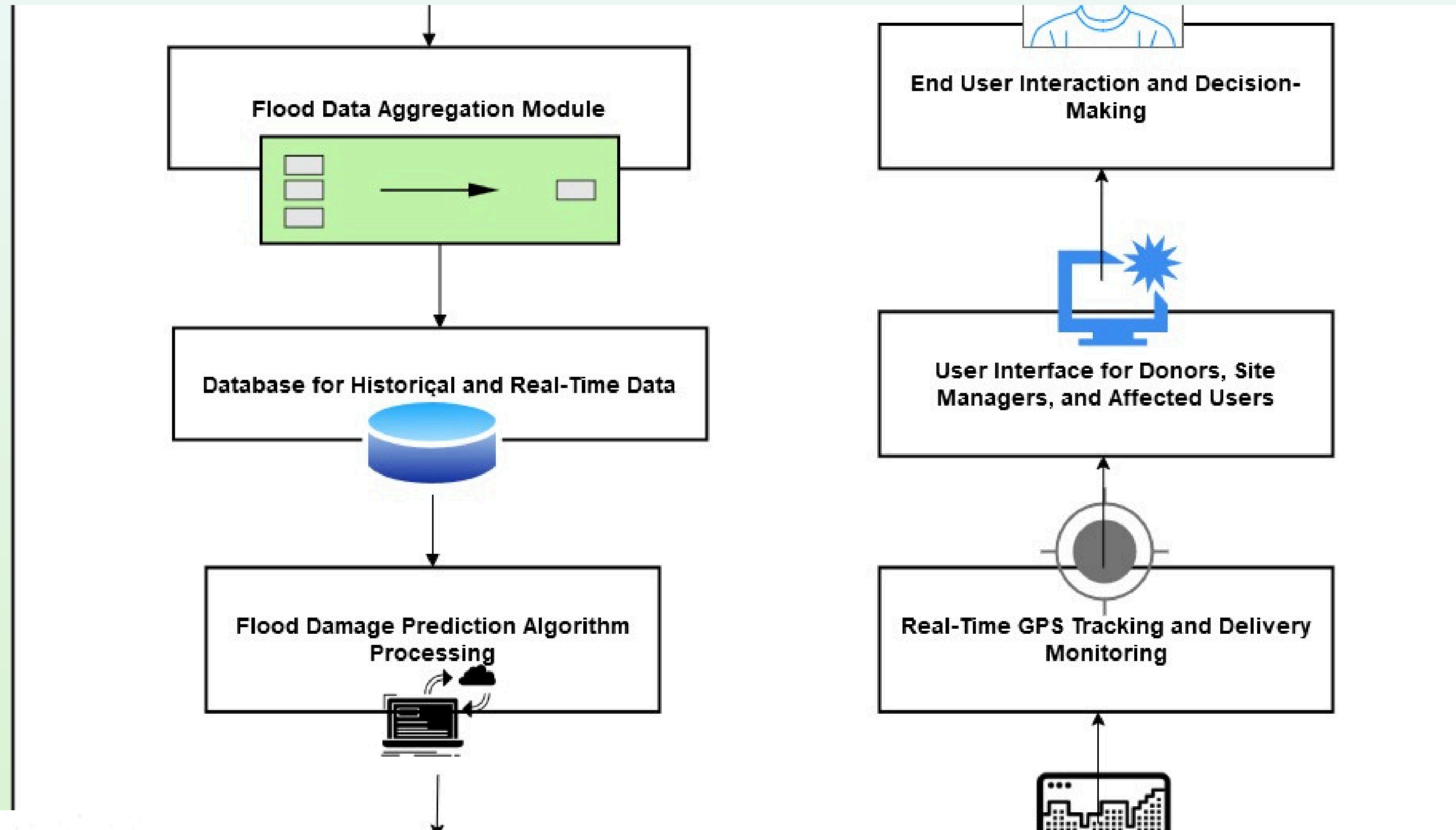
- How can a comprehensive, catchment-aware flood forecasting system be developed to
 - Predict flood related damages
 - Forecast displaced populations
 - Optimize resource allocation in Sri Lanka?



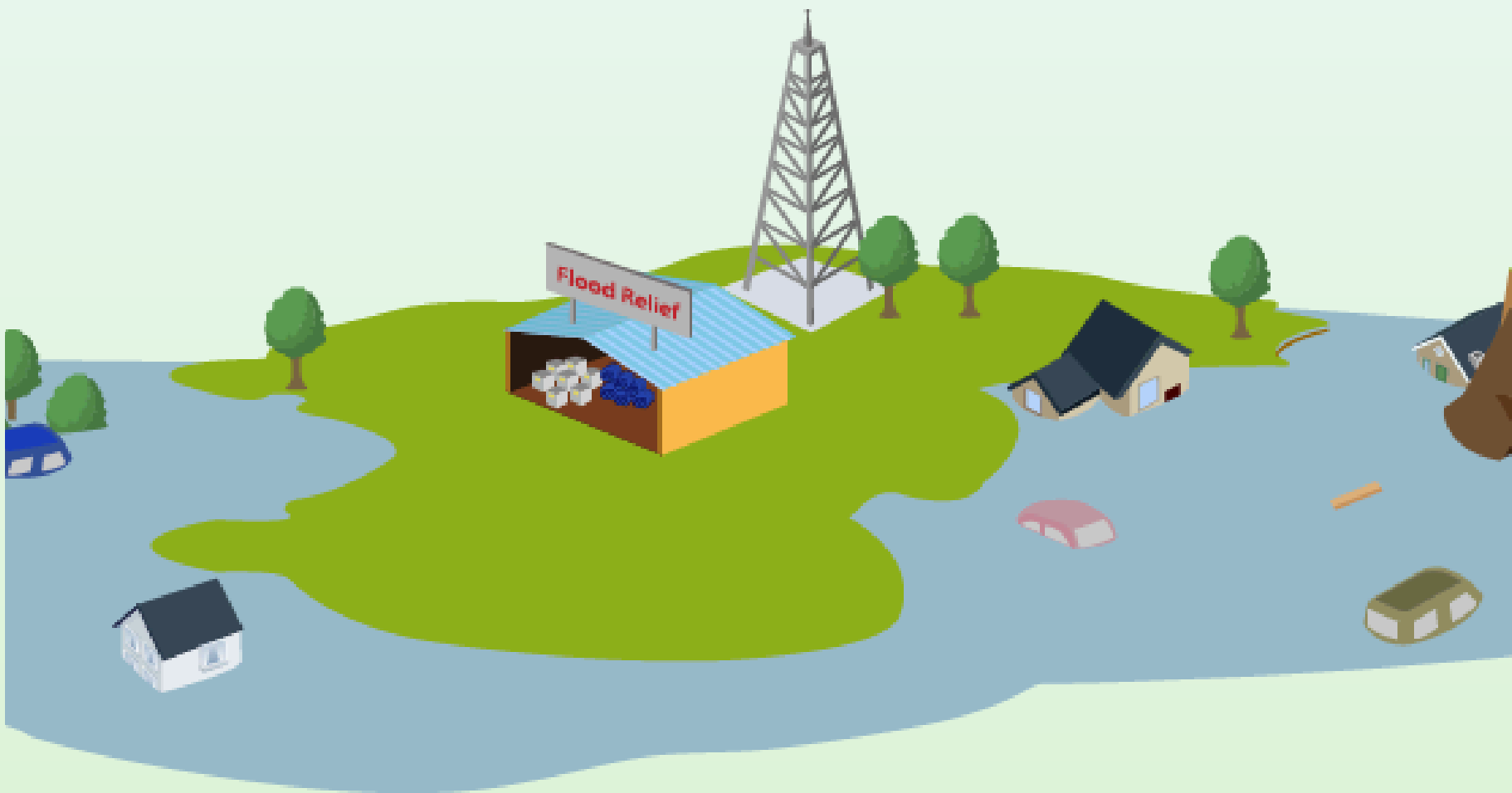
Specific Sub-Objectives

- **Flood Damage Prediction:** Develop a supervised learning model.
- **Displacement Forecasting:** Build a regression model to predict displaced populations.
- **Vehicle Tracking:** Implement GPS-enabled real-time tracking.
- **Resource Allocation Optimization:** Design an LP model for optimal resource distribution.
- **XAI Integration:** Enhance transparency and interpretability of predictions and allocations.

Methodology – System Diagram



Technologies, Techniques, and Algorithms

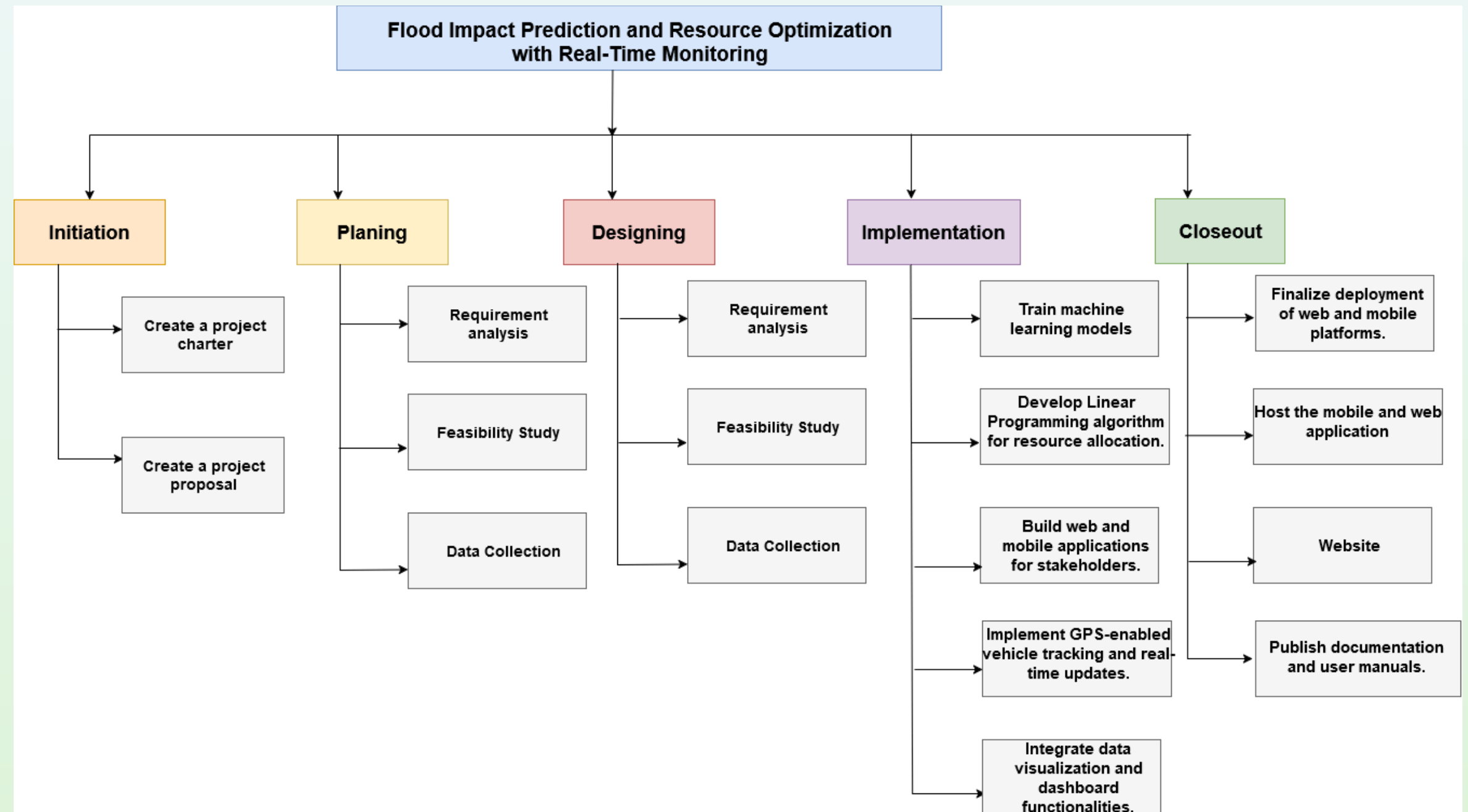


- **Machine Learning Algorithms:**
 - **Random Forest Regressor:** For flood damage prediction & displacement forecasting.
 - **Linear Programming (LP):** For resource allocation optimization.
- **Explainable AI (XAI):**
 - For interpreting predictions and resource allocation decisions.
- **Technologies:**
 - **GIS Tools:** For analyzing flood-prone areas.
 - **Mobile & Web Apps:** For real-time tracking and resource management.
 - **GPS:** For live vehicle tracking.
- **Software Frameworks:**
 - **Python** (scikit-learn, pandas) for ML models.
 - **Flask/Django** for back-end development.
 - **React Native** for mobile app development.

Functional & Non-functional Requirements

- **Functional Requirements:**
 1. Predict flood damage levels and types.
 2. Forecast displaced populations.
 3. Optimize resource allocation.
 4. Provide real-time vehicle tracking.
 5. Integrate XAI for transparency.
- **Non-functional Requirements:**
 1. **Scalability:** Expandable to other flood-prone areas.
 2. **Reliability:** High uptime during disaster events.
 3. **Performance:** Real-time predictions and updates.
 4. **Usability:** User-friendly interface.
 5. **Security:** Safe data transmission and storage.

Work Breakdown Structure



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- [1] Mester, B., Willner, S. N., Frieler, K., & Schewe, J. (2021). Evaluation of river flood extent simulated with multiple global hydrological models and climate forcings. Environmental Research Letters, 16(9). Available: <https://doi.org/10.1088/1748-9326/ac188d>
- [2] A. N. Author, et al., “A Prediction Model for Minimization of Flood Effects using Machine Learning Algorithms,” Journal Name, vol. X, no. Y, pp. Z-Z, 202X.
- [3] X. Y. Author, “Ensemble Learning Approaches for Predicting Flood Damage,” Journal of Applied Computing, vol. 14, no. 3, pp. 123-134, 2023.
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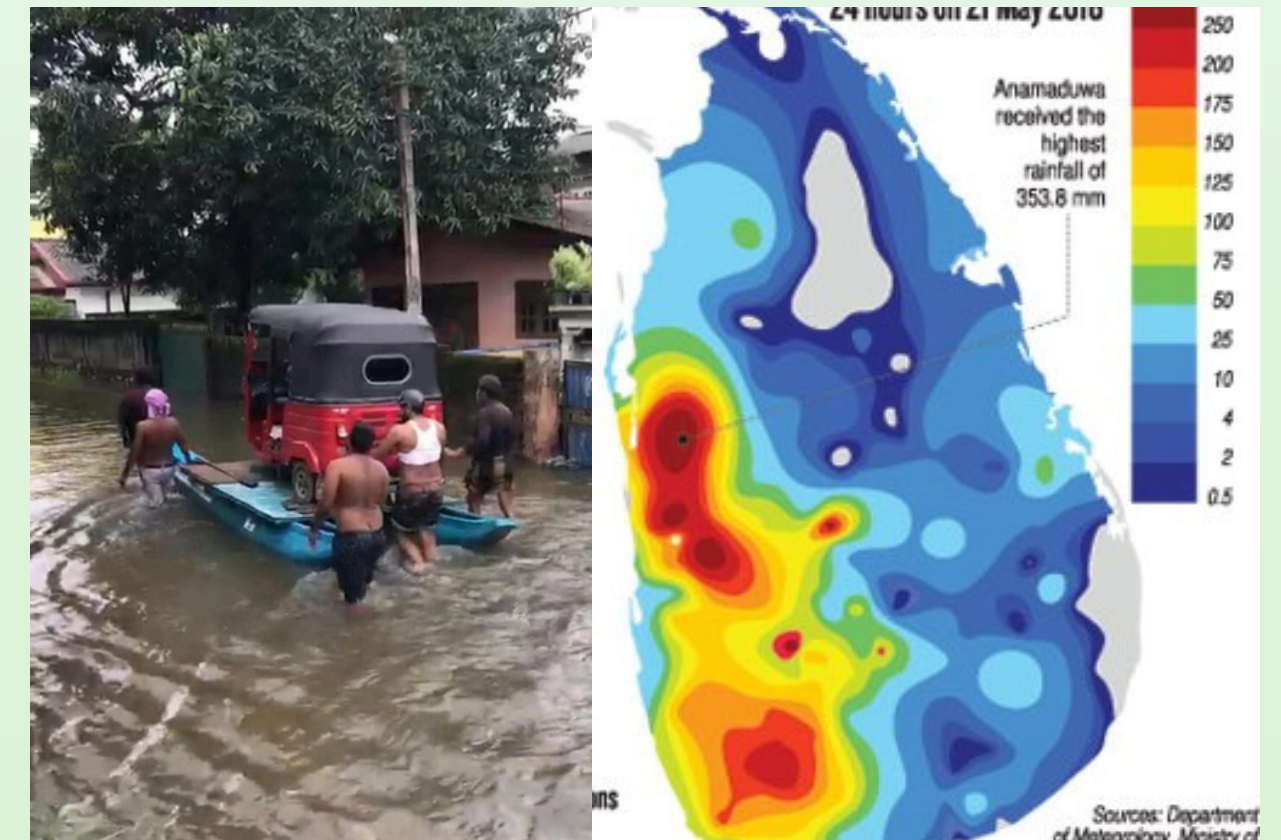
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Specialization: Information Technology



Introduction - Background

- Flooding is one of the most severe worldwide concerns, claiming millions of lives and incurring massive economic and infrastructure damage each year.
- Flood hazards are growing globally, exacerbated by climate change and increased urbanization, particularly in nations with distinct geographies such as Sri Lanka[1].
- System that addresses the complex issues of flood control by combining **Geographic Information Systems (GIS)**, **IoT** and **ML** [2], [3].



Introduction - Background

- **Predicting flood-prone locations, efficiently visualizing data, determining safe routes for transportation, and producing trustworthy reports for sharing with authorities** are the objectives of the suggested system.
- The use of both historical and real-time data to identify flood-prone locations has shown great promise for machine learning techniques[4] ,[5].
- The Catchment-Aware Flood Forecasting System has the potential to transform flood risk management and improve resilience in areas that are vulnerable to flooding by using these cutting-edge technologies

Research Question

How can people find routes for transportation when passing through flood-prone areas ?

Any existing automated system to show the possibility of flooding , which area is at high risk in real time ?

Any existing automated system to show current flood-prone areas in real-time ?



Research Gap

Aspect	Existing Systems	Gap Identified
Socio-Economic Factors	actionable and real-time	forecasting and visualizations
Real-Time Data Integration and prediction	Use past data for predictions	data not only for prediction but
Alternative Routes Suggestion	No such system exist	vehicles to pass through flood-prone areas by navigating them
Real-Time Flood prediction Visualization	A manual procedure to visualize the flood affecting predictions	equation and visualize the output in a better user

Specific and Sub-Objectives

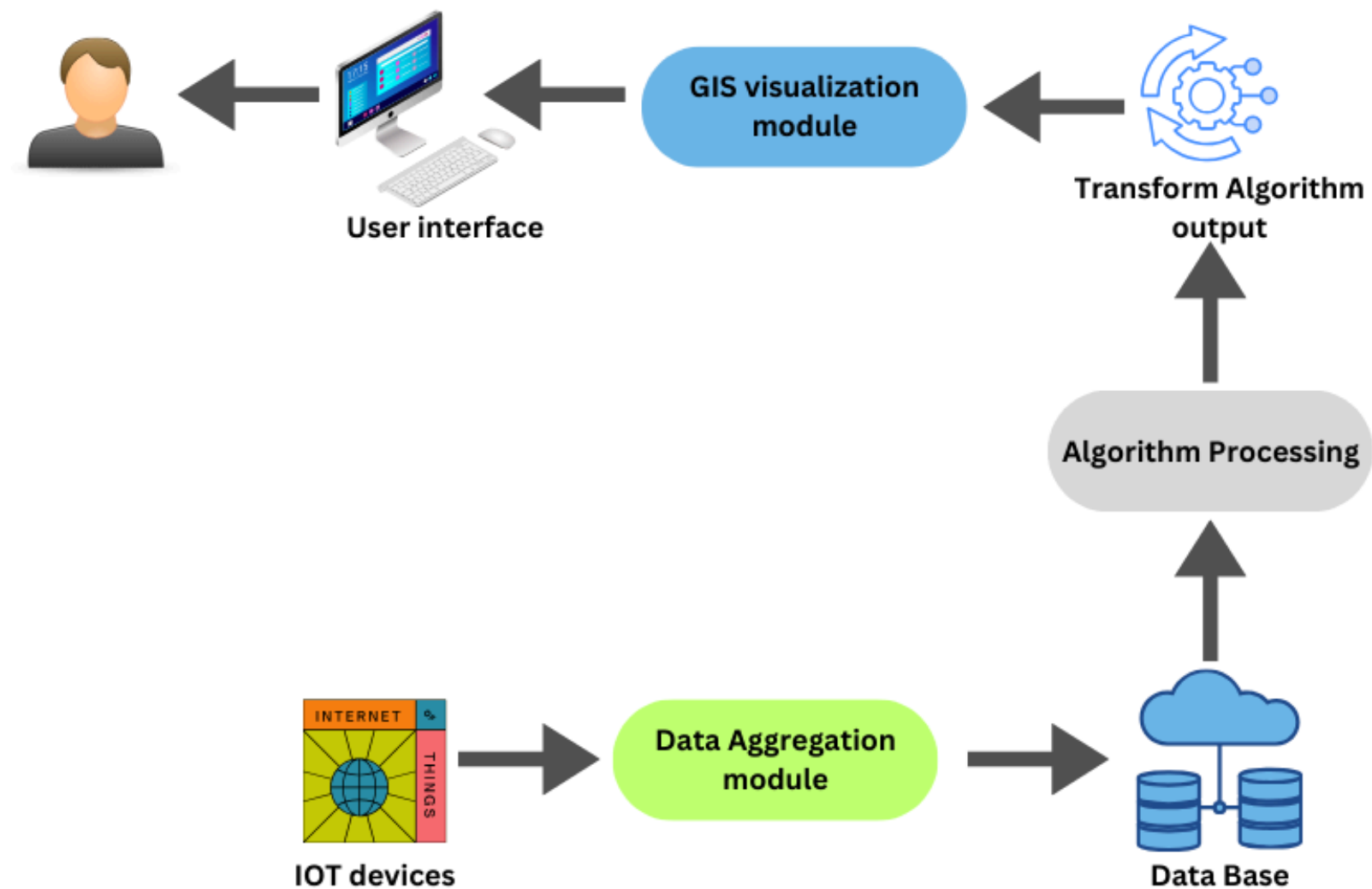
Develop an algorithm (Dijkstra's Algorithm) to identify alternative routes for the routes that are already affected by flood.

Suggesting safe routes for the people who wants to pass through flooded areas to minimize the risk and damage for transport facilities to ensure their day-to-day activities are not affected by flood.

Create predictions on flood affecting area from an equation with the use of some parameters as inputs which may cause flood occurrence use Choropleth Map visualization method .

Generating a trust worthy report for the people who are affected by flood to confirm their situation for the necessary authorities as needed.

Methodology – System Diagram



Functional, Non- Functional, and Software Requirements

Functional Requirements

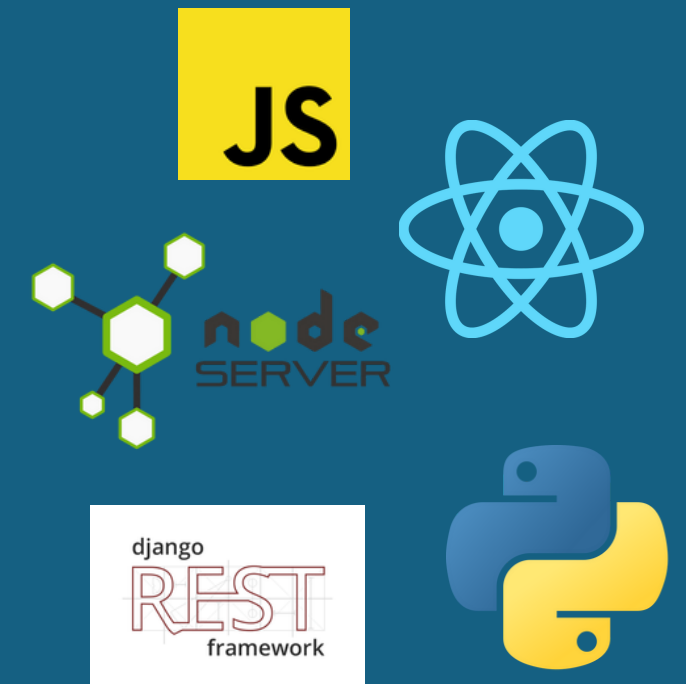
- The System should accept data like rainfall, water level of the river and wind speed data and analyze using an algorithm to predict flooding areas.
- should be able to suggest alternative routes if existing routes got affected by flood.
- Integrate real-time data from IOT devices and synchronize them in real-time

Non-Functional Requirements

- System should handle increasing volume of data from IOT devices
- Provide a user-friendly interface.
- Secure authentication mechanism.
- The system should available at any moment for the users to access even at a extreme flood situation.

Software Requirements

- React Native
- Node Server
- Python
- Django REST
- Firebase
- JavaScript
- Mapbox Studio



Methodology – Algorithms and Models

- **Machine Learning Algorithms**

- Use equation to classify risk levels as high risk, medium risk, low risk and validate the equation from the relevant authorities
- **Dijkstra's Algorithm** since it is focus on finding shortest path with smallest cumulative weight.
- **Explainable AI** Provides transparency for navigation and decision-making, building user trust.

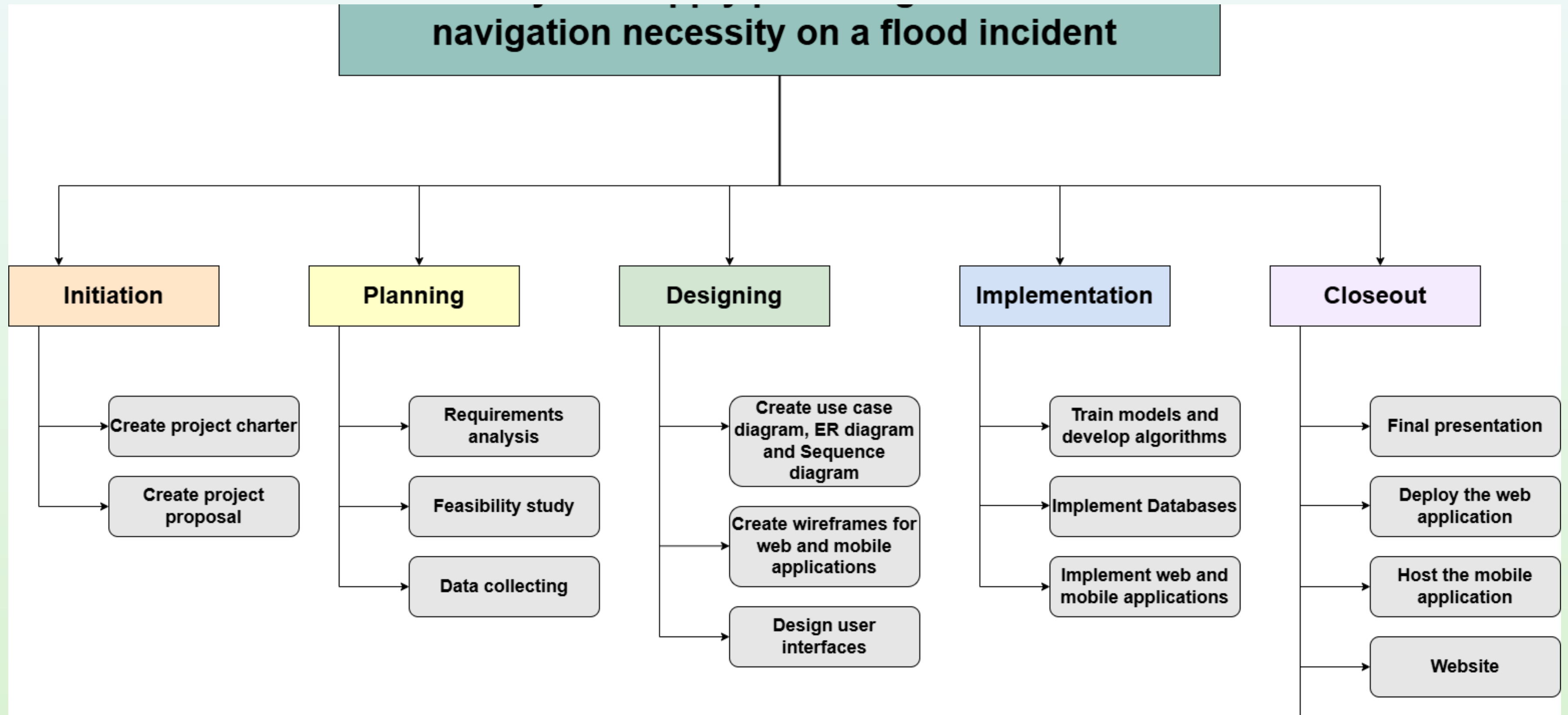
- **Technologies**

- **GIS Tools** - Geospatial analysis to calculate the shortest path and safest route to each site(QGIS).
- **GPS** - Use Google Maps API for turn-by-turn navigation to the nearest safe site
- **QTTP/HTTP** protocols to send real-time data to server.
- **Firebase** - Real-time Updates, **PostgreSQL** – Data storage

- **Software Frameworks**

- **Django REST Framework**
- **D3.js**– Visualize data of safe site statuses

Work Breakdown Structure

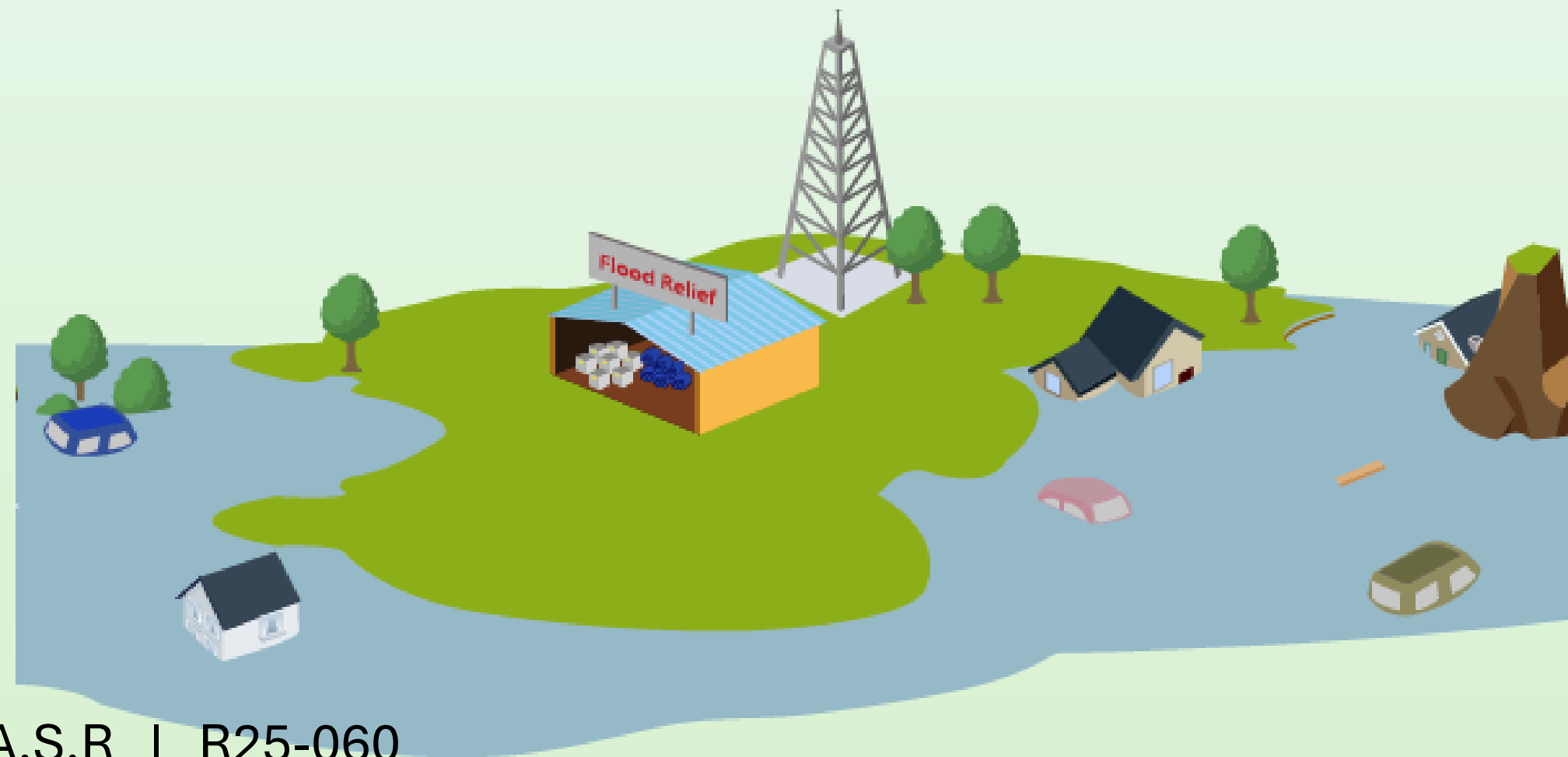


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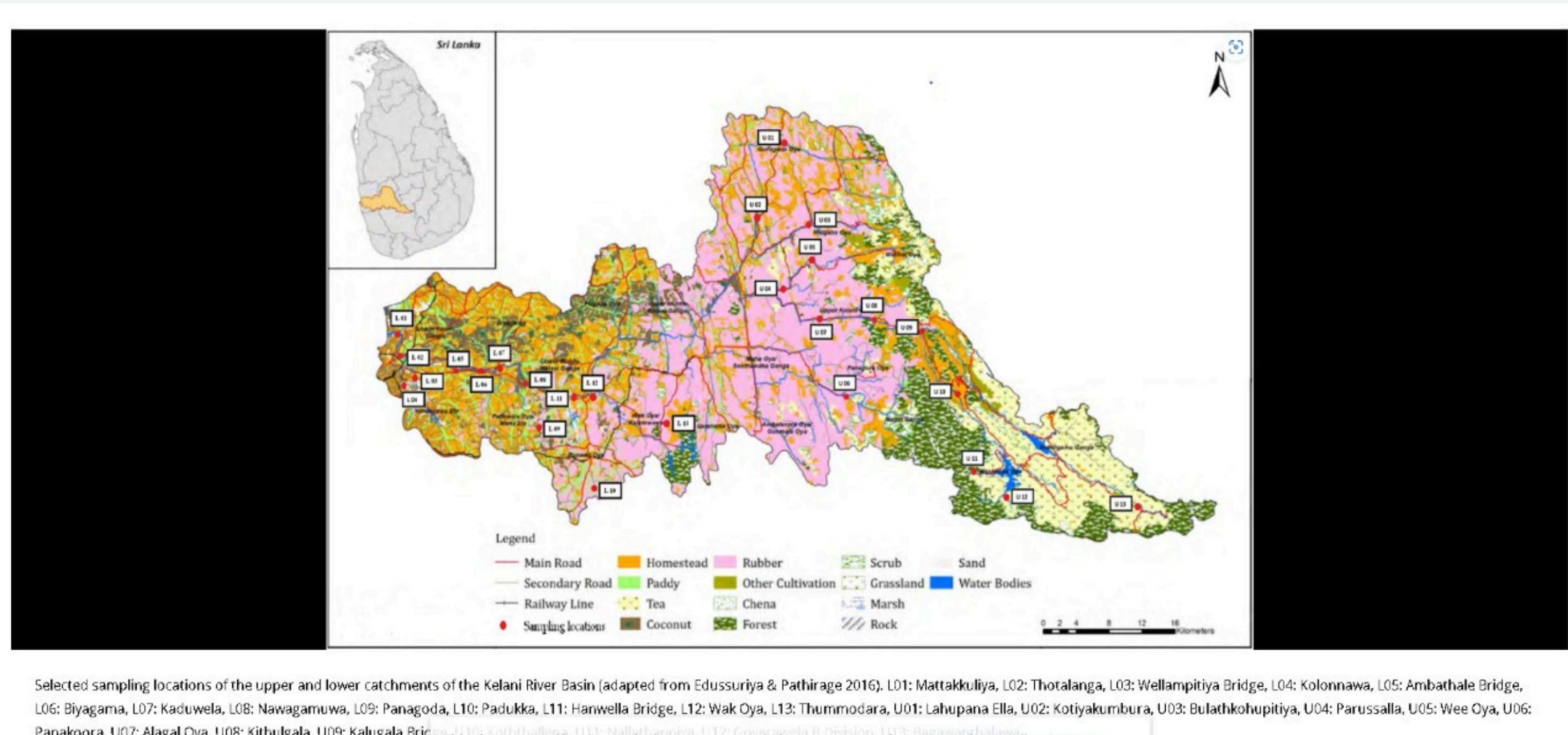
Specialization: Information Technology



Introduction - Background

- The Internet of Things (IoT) enables seamless device connectivity and communication across industries
- IoT devices generate large volumes of data requiring efficient monitoring, management, and analysis.
- By addressing device health, maintenance, and system efficiency, the dashboard supports organizations in maintaining a competitive edge in the evolving IoT landscape.

Current data collecting Centers



Research Gap

Aspect	Existing Systems	Gap Identified
Predictive Maintenance & AI Integration	Many dashboards rely on reactive maintenance .	Limited research on incorporating advanced AI/ML algorithms to anticipate failures before they happen.
Human-Computer Interaction	Some dashboards can be complex and difficult for non-technical users to understand and operate.	Limited research on optimizing the user interface and experience for different roles

Specific and Sub-Objectives

To design and implement an IoT dashboard for monitoring connected devices in real-time.

To assess user requirements for administrative tasks in IoT system management.

To analyze common device malfunctions and develop predictive maintenance strategies

To measure the operational efficiency improvements achieved through IoT systems.

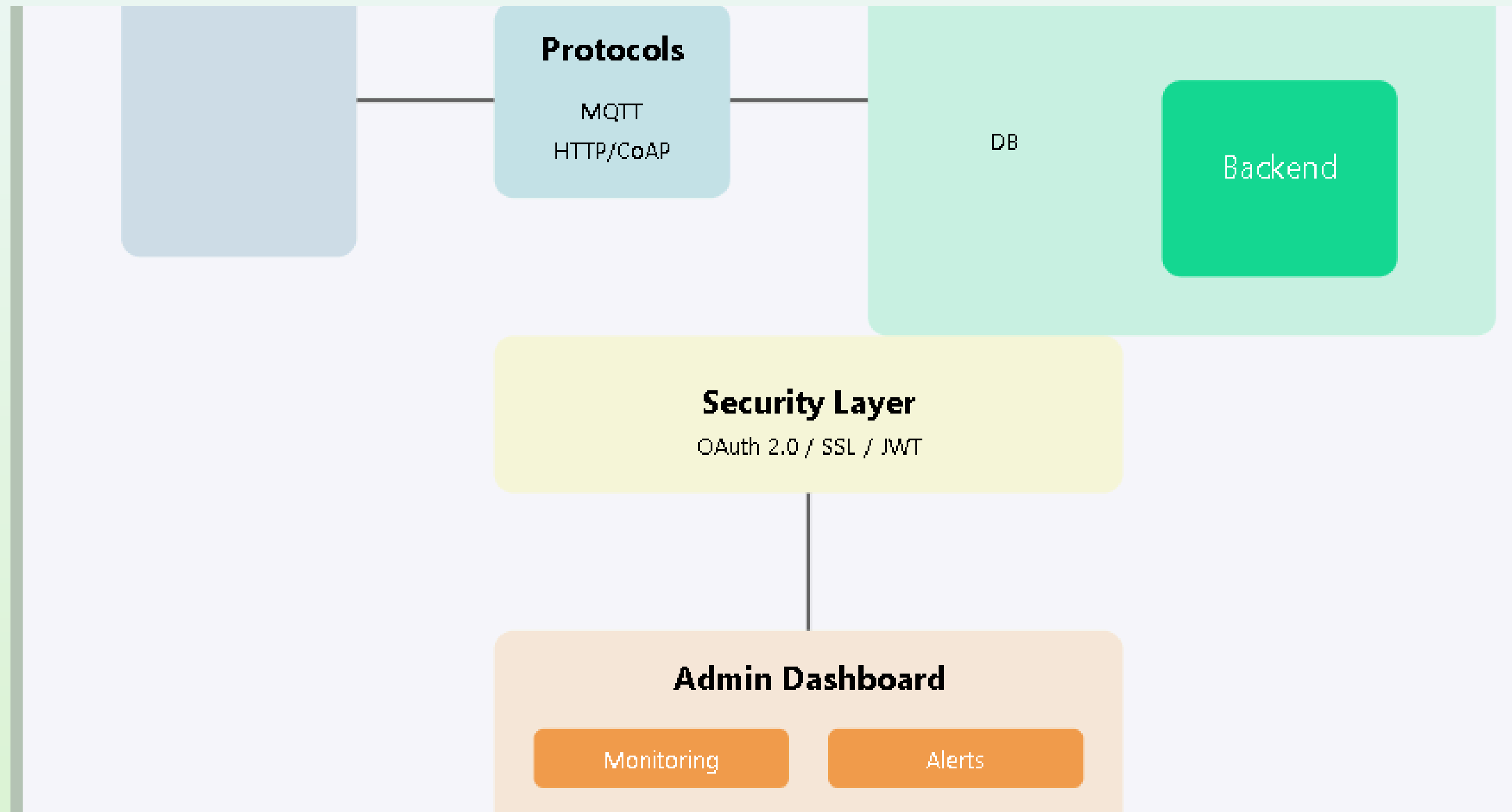
Research Question

How can an admin dashboard optimize real-time monitoring of IoT devices in a heterogeneous ecosystem?

What features are essential for a user-friendly IoT maintenance admin dashboard?

How can machine learning models be integrated into an IoT dashboard to predict device failures?

Methodology – System Diagram



Functional, Non-Functional, and Software Requirements

Functional Requirements

- Device Management
- Real-Time Monitoring
- Predictive Maintenance
- Alerts and Notifications
- Maintenance Logs and History
- User Authentication & Roles
- Dashboard Customization

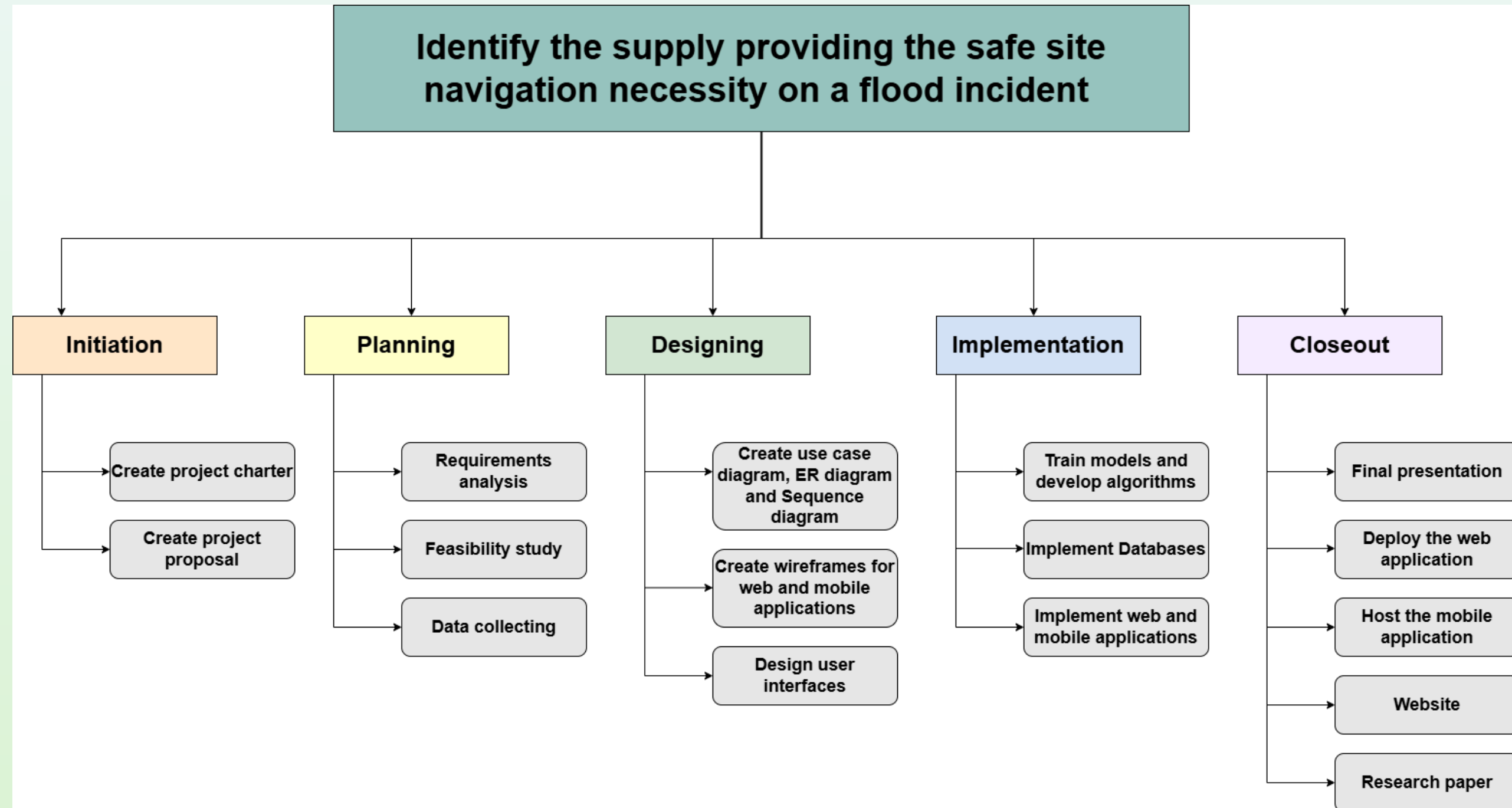
Non-Functional Requirements

- Performance
- Reliability and Availability
- Scalability
- Security
- Usability
- Data Integrity
- Compliance
- Maintainability

Software Requirements

- Angular/React.js
- Node.Js
- MongoDB
- MQTT
- PyTorch
- AWS IoT Core

Work Breakdown Structure



References

- **Hydrology and Disaster Management Division, Irrigation Department**
- Evaluation of water quality in the upper and lower catchments of the Kelani River Basin, Sri Lanka
Chandima Narangoda; Deeptha Amarathunga; Chandima Deepani Dangalle
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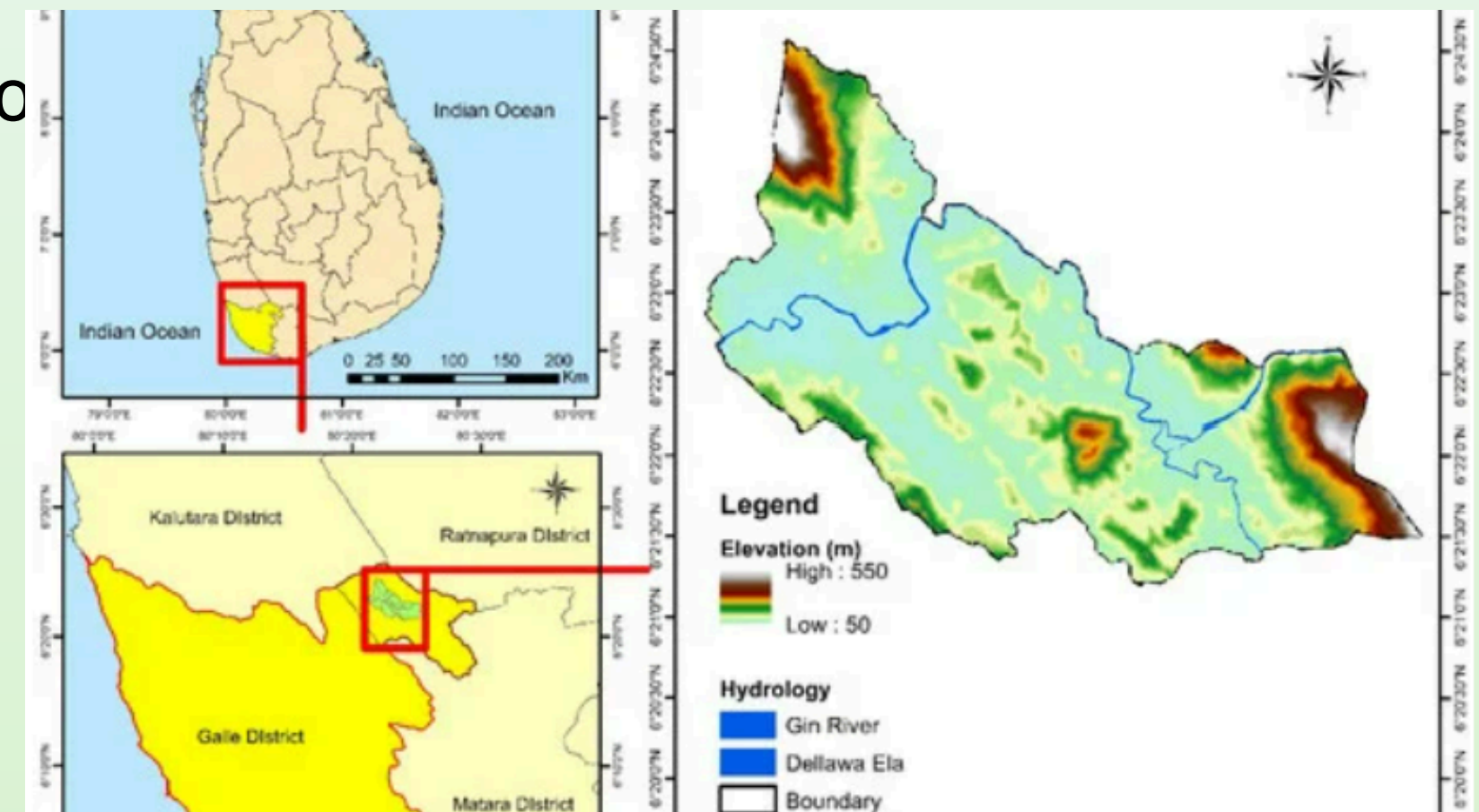
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Specialization: Information Technology



Introduction - Background

- Advanced flood forecasting and management systems are required due to the growing frequency and intensity of floods brought on by urbanization and climate change [1].
- This system integrates contemporary technologies like **artificial intelligence, geographic mapping, and predictive analytics** to handle the complex issues of flood preparedness and response [2].



Introduction - Background

- Many existing solutions focus on flood prediction and monitoring but lack comprehensive features for ensuring user safety, such as **personalized navigation to safe sites, real-time updates on supply availability, and two-way communication for support.**
- For mapping purposes, this component uses user position monitoring, predictive analytics to alert users to possible dangers, and algorithms to evaluate flood risks [3].
- Recent studies emphasize the importance of crowdsourced data in monitoring resource availability at relief centers. For instance, [4] proposed a framework that leverages IoT sensors and mobile applications to provide real-time updates on **essential supplies, including food, water, and medical resources.**

Research Question

Is there a possible way to navigate the affected people to safe locations???

How can affected people find their essential supplies??



Research Gap

Aspect	Existing Systems	Gap Identified
Socio-Economic Factors	actionable and real-time updates about safe site	Sending Alerts About Nearby Flood Risks or Safe Site changes
Navigations and directions to the nearest safe site	No such system exists	by-turn navigation to the nearest safe site
Supply requesting and providing options	No such system exists	collect supply data (e.g., food, water, medicine) via APIs or
Suggesting the Safest and Most nearby Sites to request supplies	supplies through Grama	making algorithms to rank safe sites based on proximity, crowd

Specific and Sub-Objectives

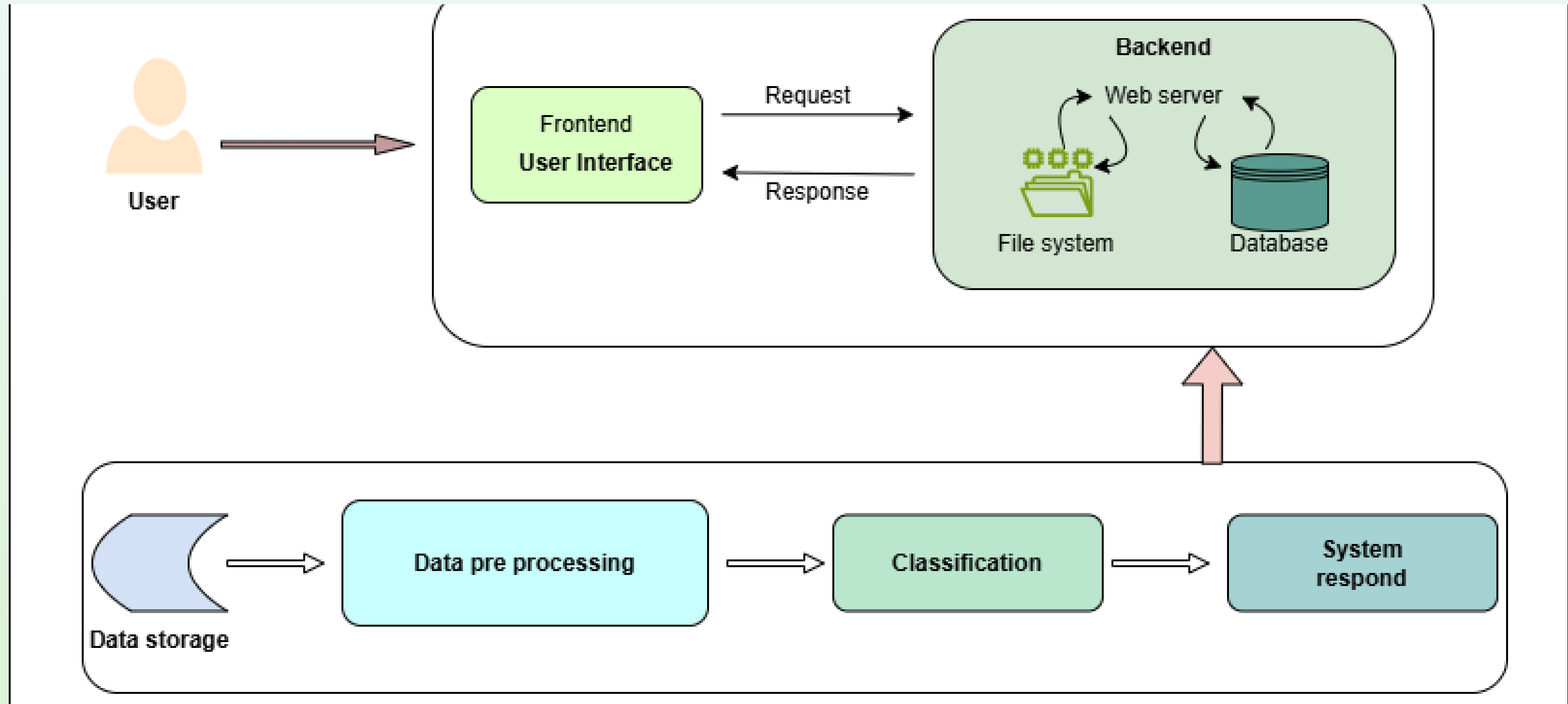
To provide security guidance to flood-affected individuals, ensuring their safety and well-being during flood events.

To establish two-way communication mechanisms for users to provide feedback, request supplies, and receive support during flood events.

To create novelty features, including dynamic suggestions for safe locations, alerts on flood risks, and real-time navigation to safety.

To enable real-time updates on safe site statuses, supply availability, and flood conditions.

Methodology – System Diagram



Functional, Non- Functional, and Software Requirements

Functional Requirements

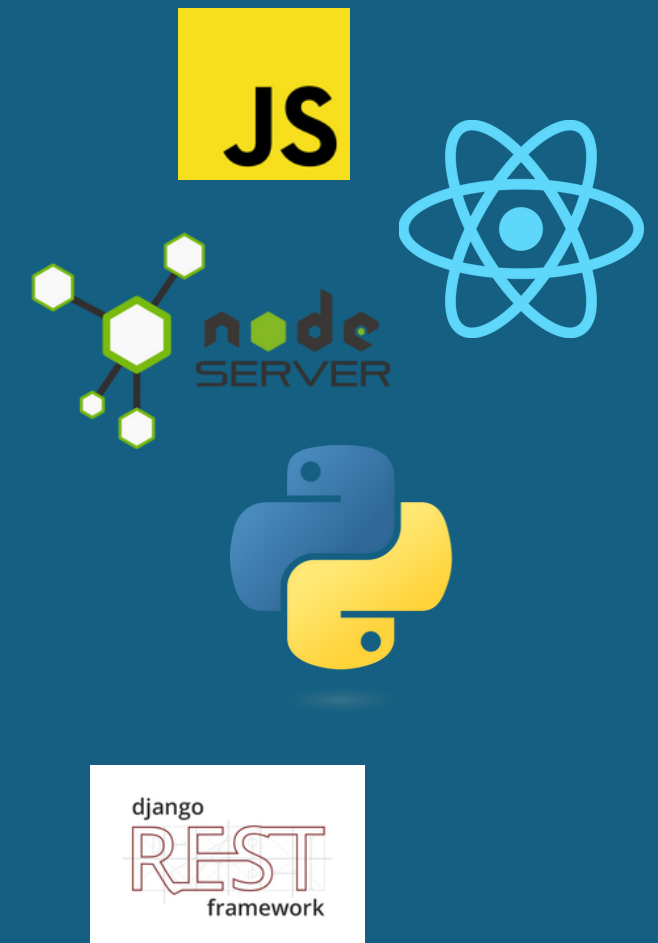
- The system should provide warnings based on weather forecasts and real-time monitoring data.
- The system should enable user location tracking for personalized guidance.
- Suggest the safest and nearest sites dynamically.
- Identify and update the status of nearby safe locations dynamically.
- Monitor the availability of essential supplies at these sites.

Non-Functional Requirements

- Guarantee 24/7 uptime during critical periods like floods.
- Provide a user-friendly interface.
- Protect user data and communication from unauthorized access.
- Ensure the system can handle a large number of users during disaster scenarios.

Software Requirements

- React Native
- Node Server
- Python
- Django REST
- Firebase
- JavaScript
- Leaf.js



Methodology – Algorithms and Models

- **Machine Learning Algorithms**

- **Random Forests, Gradient Boosting** - to analyze historical flood data, rainfall intensity, and river water levels
- **LSTM (Long Short-Term Memory)** - to process sequential data and forecast flood trends

- **Explainable AI**

- Provides transparency for navigation and decision-making, building user trust.

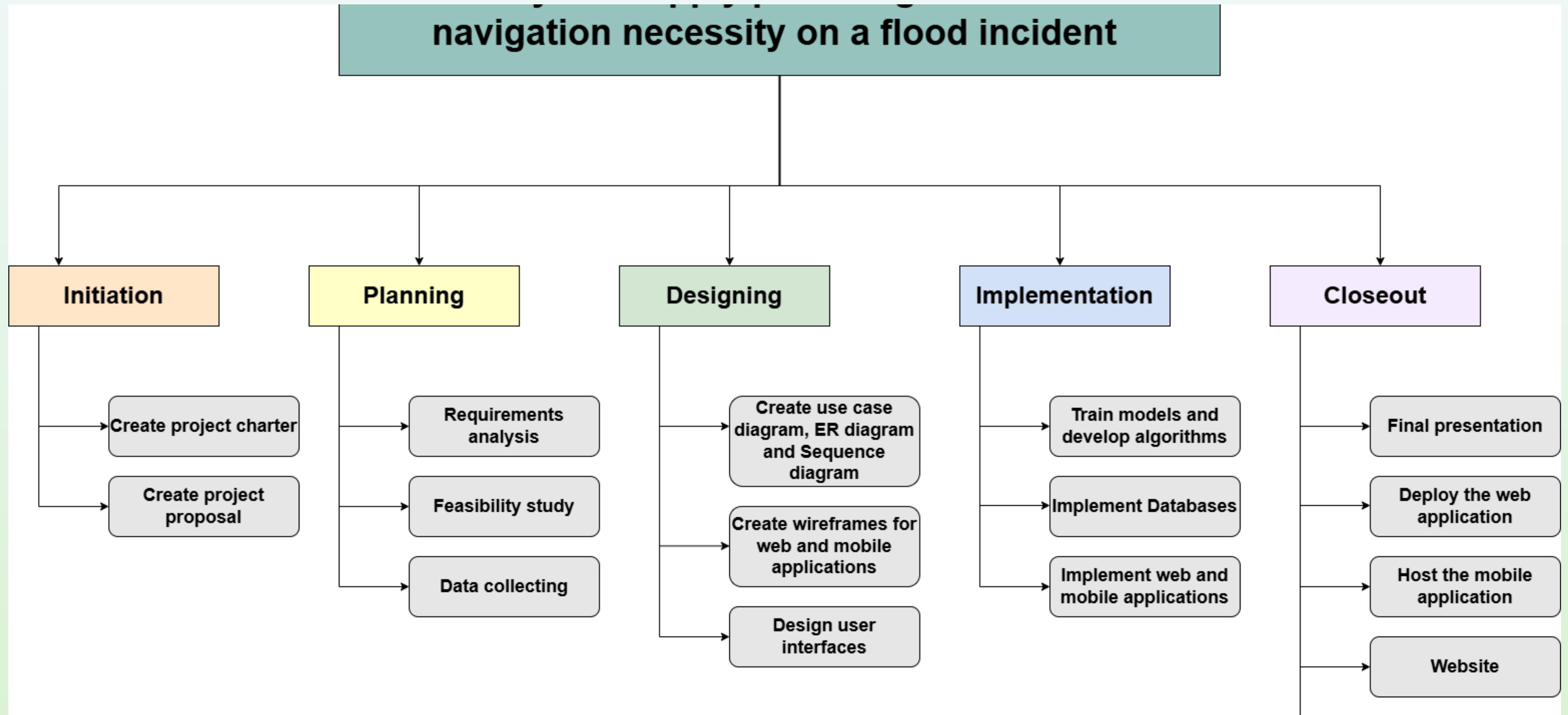
- **Technologies**

- **GIS Tools** - Geospatial analysis to calculate the shortest path and safest route to each site(QGIS).
- **Mobile and Web Applications** – For navigation purposes
- **Leaf.js** - Use for turn-by-turn navigation to the nearest safe site
- **Firebase** - Real-time Updates, **PostgreSQL** – Data storage

- **Software Frameworks**

- **Django REST Framework**
- **D3.js**– Visualize data of safe site statuses

Work Breakdown Structure



References

- [1] W. M. O. (WMO), " Guidelines on Flood Forecasting and Warning Systems.," World Meteorological Organization (WMO), 2021.
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**THANK
YOU**